

● ROBINHOOD CHAIN PRODUCT STRATEGY

Viable Products Guide

Sorted Easy → Hard · Revenue Potential · Distribution · Full Costs

Stock Tokens / RWAs · Earn / Lending · Wallet Distribution · Trading · Agents

Thesis

Robinhood Chain's real opportunity is not generic social media. It is tokenized stocks and RWAs, USDG Earn via Morpho, Wallet distribution into ~28M brokerage users, trading venues (Uniswap, Lighter, Arcus), and AI agents (MCP + onchain AA). This guide ranks products by difficulty, revenue, distribution leverage, and cost.

Compiled: July 2026 · **Audience:** Solo builders & small teams · **Mainnet:** ~July 1, 2026 (early ecosystem)

Disclaimer: Not financial, legal, or investment advice. Stock Tokens, Earn, and agents are geo-restricted. Costs are industry estimates. Verify on official docs before building.

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1. How to Read This Guide (Scoring System)

Products are ordered primarily by **difficulty** (easy → hard). Within similar difficulty, higher **revenue potential** and better **distribution fit** rank higher. Composite scores are judgment scores for a small team (solo to 3 people), not market caps.

Dimension	Scale	What it means
Difficulty	1–5 (Easy→Hard)	Tech complexity, contracts, oracles, ops, compliance load
Revenue potential	1–5	Ability to charge (SaaS, fees, AUM share) at modest scale
Distribution	1–5	Fit with RH Wallet, Earn, ST, CT, SEO, partnerships
Cash to launch	USD	Out-of-pocket if founder codes; not full founder salary
12-mo opex	USD	Hosting, RPC, tools, light marketing, basic legal
Time to MVP	Weeks	Solo full-stack baseline

Table: Scoring dimensions used throughout this guide.

Rule of thumb: Prefer products with Difficulty ≤ 2 and Revenue ≥ 3 for first revenue. Only take Difficulty ≥ 4 after revenue or funding covers audits (\$40k–\$150k+).

2. Chain Thesis & Market Context

Pillar	What is live	Builder open surface
Stock Tokens / RWAs	Tokenized equity exposure (Jersey debt securities); 24/7 onchain for eligible non-US; US persons excluded	Portfolio, tax/PnL, routing, collateral UX, analytics, eligibility UX
Earn / lending	USDG → self-custody (Privy TEE) → Morpho vault (Steakhouse); ~7% est. APY = base + incentives; not FDIC/SIPC	Risk dashboards, APY truth, alerts, power Morpho UI, borrow UX
Wallet distribution	~28M brokerage funnel; Wallet + in-app self-custody; AA (ERC-4337); early gas sponsorship narrative	Gasless onboarding, deep links, first DeFi action products
Trading	Uniswap, Pleiades/Rialto, Lighter perps, Arcus, 1inch-style routing	Best-execution UI, ST-specific tools, alerts, copy desks
Agents	Brokerage Agentic Trading via MCP; chain marketed AI-native for onchain ST/lend/swap	Strategy packs, risk wrappers, onchain AA agents with caps

Table: Official thesis pillars and where third-party builders still fit.

Critical geo split

US users: Earn / USDG / Morpho path is the hot wedge; Stock Tokens generally unavailable. **Non-US eligible users:** Stock Tokens + DeFi composability is the hot wedge. Design products with jurisdiction gates; do not assume one UX for everyone.

Official Earn mechanics: users buy USDG, move to self-custody wallet, lend via Morpho curated by Steakhouse. APY is variable; community analysis has split headline ~7% into protocol APR + Merkl-style incentives. Insurance (Lloyd's/RELM) covers Robinhood for certain technical events — not a personal user policy, not market risk.

3. Master Ranking Matrix (Easy → Hard)

Sorted by difficulty ascending. Revenue and distribution scored 1–5. “Best first bet” products are highlighted in the deep dives.

#	Product	Diff	Rev	Dist	MVP cash	MVP time	Contracts?	Best for
1	Earn / Morpho yield & risk intelligence SaaS	1	4	5	\$0.5–3k	3–6 wks	No	US / Earn
2	Stock Token portfolio + tax/PnL tracker	2	4	4	\$0.5–5k	4–8 wks	No	Non-US ST
3	ST + USDG swap / best-execution UI	2	4	4	\$0.5–8k	3–6 wks	Optional	Volume fees
4	Alerts, watchlists, ST/Earn notifier	1	3	4	\$0.3–2k	2–4 wks	No	Quick ship
5	Agent strategy packs + risk monitor (MCP)	2–3	3	4	\$1–10k	4–8 wks	No (ph1)	AI narrative
6	Morpho power-user frontend	3	3	3	\$3–15k	6–10 wks	No	DeFi natives
7	Copy desk / social trading (not keys)	3–4	4	3	\$5–25k+	8–14 wks	Optional	Trading brand
8	Onchain AA agent executor	4	4	3	\$40–120k	3–6 mo	Yes + audit	Funded team
9	Morpho curator / own vault brand	4–5	5	3	\$50k–200k+	6–12 mo	Risk ops	Risk firm
10	Own lending / ST collateral protocol	5	5	2	\$150k–500k+	9–18 mo	Yes heavy	Raise first

Table: Master ranking — Difficulty 1=easiest, Revenue/Dist 5=highest.

Revenue potential ranked (independent of difficulty)

Rev rank	Product	Primary monetization	Ceiling note
Highest	Own lending / curator at scale	Interest margin, curator fees 5–15% of yield	Needs AUM + trust
High	Swap UI with fee / referral	5–30 bps or partner revshare	Scales with volume
High	Copy trading with take-rate	Volume bps or profit share	Regulatory drag
High	Earn + ST SaaS at scale	\$8–50/mo × users + API	Steady, not explosive
Medium	Agent packs / LLM tools	Sub + usage	Commoditizes fast
Lower short-term	Pure free tools	Indirect / grants	Use as wedge only

Table: Revenue ceiling order — higher ceiling often means harder compliance/capital.

Distribution potential ranked

Dist rank	Channel	Why it works on RH Chain	Best products
1	Robinhood Earn users (US)	In-app DeFi, confused about 7% & risk	#1 Earn intelligence
2	Robinhood Wallet ST holders (non-US)	New asset class, poor portfolio tools	#2 Portfolio, #3 Swap
3	Agentic Trading curiosity	MCP is new; safety content goes viral	#5 Agent packs
4	Crypto Twitter / X	Fast feedback; noisy memecoins	All — carefully
5	SEO / YouTube education	“How does Robinhood Earn work?”	#1, #2
6	Ecosystem BD / grants	Email + Arbitrum Open House \$1M prizes	Tooling products
7	KOL / affiliate	Paid distribution	#3 swap, #7 copy

Table: Where users actually come from — match product to channel.

4. Product Deep Dives (Easy → Hard)

1. Earn / Morpho Yield & Risk Intelligence (SaaS)

Difficulty	Revenue potential	Distribution	Build effort	Cash to launch	12-mo opex
Easy (1/5)	High (4/5)	Excellent (5/5)	3–6 weeks	\$500–3,000	\$1–15k/yr

Composite score: Diff 1 · Rev 4 · Dist 5 · **Overall: TOP PICK (US)** | Best first bet for US-focused builders — zero contracts, clear pain, subscription revenue.

What to build

Dashboard for Robinhood Earn / Morpho vaults on Robinhood Chain: split real APY (protocol interest vs incentives), utilization, withdraw liquidity, curator parameter change feed, historical rates, “what if incentives end” scenarios, Telegram/email alerts on rate drops or high utilization.

Why it fits Robinhood Chain

Earn is the US distribution wedge. Official app is simple; disclosures and Reddit already show confusion about variable ~7%, incentives, smart contract risk, and insurance limits. You provide clarity without custody.

Who pays / revenue model

Pro retail \$8–20/mo; power users; later B2B/API for creators and tools. Affiliate optional.

Revenue detail: 200 × \$12 = \$2.4k MRR. Freemium free tier for growth. API \$49–499/mo later. Do not promise yields. Monetize insight and alerts.

Distribution strategy

Distribution: SEO “Robinhood Earn explained”; X threads on APY breakdown; Reddit r/RobinhoodApp (value, not spam); YouTube explainers; share vault health when rates change; email chain-developers-group@robinhood.com as ecosystem tool; Arbitrum grants angle: transparency tooling for retail DeFi.

Build shape

Read-only indexer + Next.js app + wallet optional. No custom smart contracts. Morpho/public RPC + indexer.

Cost breakdown

Item	Low / MVP	Solid v1
Dev time (solo)	3–6 weeks	2–3 months
Hosting + DB + jobs	\$20–80/mo	\$100–400/mo
RPC / Alchemy	\$0–freemium	\$200–500/mo
Custom contracts	\$0	\$0
Audit	\$0	\$0
Legal (ToS/disclaimer)	\$0–1k templates	\$2–5k review
Cash to launch	\$200–1,500	\$3–10k
12-month opex	~\$1–4k	~\$5–15k

Main risks

Low technical risk. Reputation risk if you overstate safety. Keep educational tone. Rates/incentives change — refresh data quality.

2. Stock Token Portfolio + Tax / PnL Tracker

Difficulty	Revenue potential	Distribution	Build effort	Cash to launch	12-mo opex
Easy–Med (2/5)	High (4/5)	Strong (4/5)	4–8 weeks	\$500–5,000	\$5–20k/yr

Composite score: Diff 2 · Rev 4 · Dist 4 · **Overall: TOP PICK (Non-US)** | Best first bet for non-US / Stock Token builders — portfolio job is unsolved.

What to build

Connect wallet → list Stock Token positions, cost basis, 24/7 marks vs traditional close (where useful), unrealized/realized PnL, multi-venue trade history (e.g. Uniswap), CSV export for accountants, eligibility banners.

Why it fits Robinhood Chain

ST is a new asset class on RH Chain. Brokerage-quality portfolio tracking is missing. Users buy NVDA/AAPL-linked tokens and lack “what do I hold and what did I make?” tools. Aligns with RWA thesis without competing with Uniswap itself.

Who pays / revenue model

Subscription \$10–30/mo Pro; accountant seats later; B2B white-label for wallets.

Revenue detail: 300 × \$15 = \$4.5k MRR. Annual plans. Export-only free tier. Partnerships with tax tools. High willingness to pay among active traders.

Distribution strategy

Distribution: Non-US crypto Twitter; Wallet user communities; content “Stock Tokens tax tracking”; list on RH ecosystem page when ready; DEXs refer for post-trade; SEO on ticker + tokenized stock.

Build shape

Wallet connect (viem/wagmi), indexer for transfers/swaps, price feeds (Chainlink + ST metadata), Next.js UI. No custody.

Cost breakdown

Item	Low / MVP	Solid v1
Dev time	4–8 weeks	3–4 months
Indexer (subgraph/custom)	\$50–150/mo	\$200–800/mo
Price / data	Mostly public	\$0–300/mo
Hosting	\$20–100/mo	\$100–400/mo
Contracts / audit	\$0	\$0
Legal disclaimers	\$500–3k	\$3–8k
Cash to launch	\$500–3k	\$5–15k

Main risks

Data accuracy liability → heavy disclaimers. Geo: never market ST tools to US persons. Oracle/mark discrepancies.

3. Stock Token + USDG Best-Execution / Swap UI

Difficulty	Revenue potential	Distribution	Build effort	Cash to launch	12-mo opex
Easy–Med (2/5)	High (4/5)	Strong (4/5)	3–6 weeks (UI)	\$500–8,000 UI / \$20–55k with router	Varies

Composite score: Diff 2 · Rev 4 · Dist 4 · **Overall: BEST FEE PATH (start UI-only)** | Volume-native revenue; ship UI-first without custom router.

What to build

One screen: buy \$X of a Stock Token with USDG/ETH; compare Uniswap vs other venues; show price impact, fees, gas; eligibility warning; optional gas sponsorship via Alchemy AA.

Why it fits Robinhood Chain

Trading is core thesis. Retail cannot compare venues. Official stack has multiple AMMs/routers — clarity wins.

Who pays / revenue model

Swap fee share 5–30 bps; or free + Pro charts; partner referrals from DEXs.

Revenue detail: At \$2M monthly volume and 10 bps = \$2k/mo. Scales linearly. UI-only can use affiliate until volume justifies audit.

Distribution strategy

Distribution: Default landing after “I want ST”; Twitter quote tools; embed widgets; Wallet deep links; compete on UX not liquidity ownership.

Build shape

Phase 1: pure frontend deep-linking / quoting Uniswap (no custody). Phase 2: fee-taking router contract + audit.

Cost breakdown

Item	Low / MVP	Solid v1
UI-only build	3–6 weeks / \$0.5–2k cash	Polished 2–3 mo
Fee router contract	\$2–8k dev	—
Audit if routing value	\$0 (UI-only)	\$15–40k
Infra	\$50–200/mo	\$100–400/mo
Cash to launch	\$500–2k (UI)	\$20–55k (with audit)

Main risks

Medium if custom router (MEV, routing bugs). Low if pure UI. Compliance if you look like a broker — counsel before fees.

4. Alerts, Watchlists & Notifier (ST / Earn / Perps)

Difficulty	Revenue potential	Distribution	Build effort	Cash to launch	12-mo opex
Easy (1/5)	Medium (3/5)	Strong (4/5)	2–4 weeks	\$300–2,000	\$1–8k/yr

Composite score: Diff 1 · Rev 3 · Dist 4 · **Overall: FAST WEDGE / FEATURE** | Fastest ship; often a feature of #1/#2 — can also be standalone wedge.

What to build

Price alerts on Stock Tokens, Earn APY threshold alerts, Morpho utilization alerts, large trade / whale alerts, Telegram bot + email + web push.

Why it fits Robinhood Chain

24/7 markets need 24/7 attention tools. Robinhood app won't cover every onchain condition early.

Who pays / revenue model

Freemium: free limited alerts; Pro \$5–12/mo unlimited + SMS optional.

Revenue detail: Lower ARPU than full SaaS; high conversion from free. Good upsell into #1/#2.

Distribution strategy

Distribution: Viral “set this alert” posts; bot invite links; embed in content creator workflows.

Build shape

Workers + webhooks + simple DB. Can share backend with product #1 or #2.

Cost breakdown

Item	Low / MVP	Solid v1
Dev	2–4 weeks	6–8 weeks
Messaging (Telegram free; SMS \$)	\$0–50/mo	\$50–300/mo

Item	Low / MVP	Solid v1
Infra	\$20–80/mo	\$100–250/mo
Audit	\$0	\$0
Cash to launch	\$300–1k	\$2–5k

Main risks

Spam regulations for SMS. Alert fatigue. Don't spam X users.

5. Agent Strategy Packs + Risk Monitor (MCP Phase 1)

Difficulty	Revenue potential	Distribution	Build effort	Cash to launch	12-mo opex
Med (2–3/5)	Med–High (3/5)	Strong (4/5)	4–8 weeks	\$1–10,000	\$15–40k/yr w/ LLM

Composite score: Diff 2–3 · Rev 3 · Dist 4 · **Overall: STRONG NARRATIVE FIT** | Ride the agent narrative without building a full onchain agent (yet).

What to build

Productized strategies and guardrail templates for Robinhood Agentic Trading (brokerage MCP): DCA packs, rebalance rules, max daily loss language, checklist UX, monitoring dashboard. User connects their own agent (Claude/ChatGPT/etc.) via official MCP; you sell templates + monitoring — not custody.

Why it fits Robinhood Chain

RH heavily markets agentic trading (MCP endpoint agent.robinhood.com/mcp/trading). Users fear runaway bots. Safety and templates are the product. Phase 2 can move onchain later.

Who pays / revenue model

\$15–50/mo; usage-based LLM if you host runners (higher reg risk — prefer user-hosted agent).

Revenue detail: Content-led growth; subscriptions. Avoid AUM fees without licenses. Never guarantee returns. Tools/templates framing only.

Distribution strategy

Distribution: YouTube “safe agentic setup”; X demos; SEO; partnership with agent platforms; RH agent narrative content.

Build shape

Content + SaaS app. No chain contracts in phase 1. Optional LLM API for strategy generation.

Cost breakdown

Item	Low / MVP	Solid v1
Phase 1 SaaS	\$1–8k cash	2–3 months polish
LLM API opex	\$50–500/mo	\$500–2k/mo at scale
Phase 2 onchain AA agent	—	\$40–120k + audit
Legal (advice boundaries)	\$1–5k	\$5–15k

Main risks

High regulatory risk if personalized advice or managing money. Stay software tools. Liability if templates lose money — disclaimers.

6. Morpho Power-User Frontend (Beyond Earn)

Difficulty	Revenue potential	Distribution	Build effort	Cash to launch	12-mo opex
Med (3/5)	Med (3/5)	Med (3/5)	6–10 weeks	\$3–15,000	\$5–25k/yr

Composite score: Diff 3 · Rev 3 · Dist 3 · **Overall: SOLID IF YOU KNOW DEFI** | For DeFi-native users who export wallets or want more than one vault.

What to build

Full Morpho markets UI on RH Chain: supply USDG, explore collateral markets, health factors, liquidation awareness, multi-market view. Complements — does not replace — Robinhood Earn’s one-tap vault.

Why it fits Robinhood Chain

Earn is one curated vault. Power users and exported-wallet users need a home. Morpho is official lending primitive.

Who pays / revenue model

Referral fees; later optional curator partnership; Pro analytics.

Revenue detail: Moderate until AUM referrals. Curator path is separate (see #9).

Distribution strategy

Distribution: DeFi Twitter; Morpho community; “export wallet then manage here” content; power users from Earn who outgrow simple UI.

Build shape

Frontend on Morpho SDK/contracts; wallet connect; read+write to existing protocol — no new lending math if pure frontend.

Cost breakdown

Item	Low / MVP	Solid v1
Frontend build	\$3–10k time/cash	\$10–20k polished
Audit	\$0 pure frontend	If wrappers: \$40k+
Infra	\$50–200/mo	\$200–500/mo

Main risks

Competing with official simplicity. UX must be excellent. Don't imply affiliation with Robinhood/Morpho.

7. Copy Desk / Social Trading (Not Friend.tech Keys)

Difficulty	Revenue potential	Distribution	Build effort	Cash to launch	12-mo opex
Med–Hard (3–4/5)	High (4/5)	Med (3/5)	8–14 weeks	\$5–25,000+	Higher legal opex

Composite score: Diff 3–4 · Rev 4 · Dist 3 · **Overall: HIGH CEILING, LEGAL FIRST** | Trading thesis + social distribution — different from GreenTown key casino.

What to build

Follow wallets with transparent PnL; optional auto-copy with max allocation and kill switch; fee on copy volume. Asset rooms optional later. Not bonding-curve keys.

Why it fits Robinhood Chain

Users want “who to follow” for ST/perps without pure speculation social. Aligns with trading + wallet habits.

Who pays / revenue model

10–20% profit share or volume bps; Pro leaderboards.

Revenue detail: High if volume works. Friend.tech-like hype is wrong model; durable PnL trust is right.

Distribution strategy

Distribution: Trader KOLs; X leaderboards; perps communities (Lighter); careful paid KOL tests.

Build shape

Phase 1: signal feed + manual follow (no auto-exec). Phase 2: onchain/copy vault + audit + legal.

Cost breakdown

Item	Low / MVP	Solid v1
Signals UI only	\$5–15k	—
Onchain copy + audit	—	\$50–150k+
Legal / compliance	\$5–25k	Ongoing counsel
Infra	\$100–400/mo	\$300–1k/mo

Main risks

Regulatory: copy trading may be treated as advisory/brokerage by jurisdiction. Budget counsel. Scam leaders — need filtering.

8. Onchain AA Agent Executor (Guarded Agents on RH Chain)

Difficulty	Revenue potential	Distribution	Build effort	Cash to launch	12-mo opex
Hard (4/5)	High (4/5)	Med (3/5)	3–6 months	\$40–120,000	\$30–100k/yr

Composite score: Diff 4 · Rev 4 · Dist 3 · **Overall: FUNDED / POST-REVENUE** | Only after phase-1 agent demand or funding — contracts + audit required.

What to build

Session keys / ERC-4337 account abstraction agents that can swap, lend USDG, rebalance ST within hard caps set by user. Kill switch. Human remains in control of limits.

Why it fits Robinhood Chain

Chain is marketed AI-native; AA is first-class. Fills gap between brokerage MCP and onchain ST/Earn automation.

Who pays / revenue model

SaaS + per-execution fee or % of AUM (careful: regs). Gas sponsorship margin.

Revenue detail: Strong if sticky automation. High trust bar. Enterprise later.

Distribution strategy

Distribution: Agent Twitter; showcase on RH AI narrative; Open House demos; security-first marketing.

Build shape

Solidity AA modules, policy engine, frontend, monitoring, formal audit, bug bounty.

Cost breakdown

Item	Low / MVP	Solid v1
Contracts + frontend	\$20–50k	Team cost higher
Audit	\$40–100k	Remediation extra
Bug bounty	\$5–25k	—
Infra + AA gas	\$200–2k/mo	Scales with users
Cash to launch	\$40–120k	—

Main risks

Smart contract risk, agent misbehavior, regulatory classification. Do not skip audit.

9. Morpho Vault Curator Brand (Compete/Complement Earn)

Difficulty	Revenue potential	Distribution	Build effort	Cash to launch	12-mo opex
Hard (4–5/5)	Very High (5/5)	Med (3/5)	6–12 months	\$50–200,000+	Ops-heavy

Composite score: Diff 4–5 · Rev 5 · Dist 3 · **Overall: ONLY WITH RISK EXPERTISE** | Risk firm business — not a weekend app. Steakhouse-style curation.

What to build

Curate Morpho vaults with own risk parameters, allocations, documentation, and fee model (management and/or performance fees, often ~5–15% of yield in industry practice). Possibly differentiate on ST collateral markets or non-US strategies where legal.

Why it fits Robinhood Chain

Curators are the silent winners of Morpho: fees on AUM without building full lending primitive. Earn already uses Steakhouse — room for specialized vaults, not easy “clone Earn.”

Who pays / revenue model

Curator fees on deposits; distributor revshare with frontends.

Revenue detail: Example industry narrative: meaningful ARR at large AUM. At \$50M AUM and 1% effective fee ≈ \$500k/yr — hard to reach. Start only with risk credibility.

Distribution strategy

Distribution: Institutional + DeFi-native; integrations with frontends; not CT memes.

Build shape

Risk team, monitoring, governance/timelocks, legal, reputation, liquidity relationships. Steakhouse reached large AUM with lean team but deep expertise — not beginner path.

Cost breakdown

Item	Low / MVP	Solid v1
Risk + ops team	Ongoing salaries	Main cost
Monitoring infra	\$500–5k/mo	—
Legal / entity	\$10–50k+	—
Audit / reviews	\$20–80k	Ongoing
Cash / runway	\$50–200k+ year 1	Until fee AUM

Main risks

Curation risk is real (disclosed in Robinhood Earn). Bad parameters → user losses → brand death. Capital intensive.

10. Own Lending Protocol / ST Collateral Market

Difficulty	Revenue potential	Distribution	Build effort	Cash to launch	12-mo opex
Hardest (5/5)	Very High (5/5)	Low–Med (2/5)	9–18 months	\$150–500,000+	\$300k–1M+

Composite score: Diff 5 · Rev 5 · Dist 2 · **Overall: RAISE OR SKIP** | Protocol ambition — raise first. Do not start here.

What to build

New borrow/lend markets specialized for Stock Tokens: oracles, LTVs, liquidations, risk engines, insurance narratives, multi-asset collateral.

Why it fits Robinhood Chain

Official story says ST can be collateral in DeFi — building the full protocol captures interest margin but fights Morpho/Aave-style gravity and needs deep liquidity + security.

Who pays / revenue model

Interest spread, liquidation fees, token incentives (optional, dangerous).

Revenue detail: Highest ceiling if successful; most projects fail or never get TVL.

Distribution strategy

Distribution: Needs RH/ecosystem partnership or massive incentives. Cold start is brutal.

Build shape

Full protocol engineering, multiple audits, bug bounties, market makers, legal, liquidity mining budget.

Cost breakdown

Item	Low / MVP	Solid v1
Engineering team	\$200k+/yr	—
Audits (multi)	\$100–250k+	—
Liquidity / incentives	\$50–500k+	—
Legal	\$50–250k+	Securities issues
Total year-1	\$150k–500k+ lean	\$1M+ serious

Main risks

Smart contract exploits, oracle failure, regulatory (RWA collateral), liquidity death spiral.

5. Cost Reference Tables

5.1 Infrastructure (monthly)

Item	Indie	Growth	Notes
Hosting (Railway/Vercel)	\$20–50	\$100–400	FE + API split like GreenTown pattern
Postgres / Redis	\$15–50	\$50–200	Supabase, Neon, Railway
RPC / Alchemy	\$0–50	\$200–500+	RH recommends Alchemy; AA gas extra
Indexer workers	\$20–100	\$200–800	Critical for portfolio products
Sentry / analytics	\$0–30	\$50–200	GA4 free tier ok early
LLM APIs	\$50–200	\$500–2,000+	Agents only
Domain + email	\$5–15	\$20–50	Google Workspace etc.
Total typical	\$50–400	\$500–2,500+	Before salaries

Table: Monthly infra ranges.

5.2 Smart contract audits (2026 market)

Scope	Typical audit cost	When needed
Simple ERC-20 / minimal	\$5–20k	Rarely your MVP
Fee router / simple vault wrapper	\$15–40k	If you take fees onchain
Mid DeFi protocol	\$40–100k	Vaults, leverage, complex money flow
Complex lending / AMM	\$50–150k+	New protocol
Full pre-launch package	\$60–120k common	Audit + remediation pass
Bug bounty pool	\$5–50k	After audit

Sources: 2026 audit market references (Sherlock, industry blogs). Arbitrum audit subsidy may offset later — do not depend on it for launch.

5.3 People (if not solo)

Role	Monthly (rough)	Notes
Full-stack contractor	\$6–15k	US/EU rates; lower offshore
Solidity part-time	\$4–10k	Only when contracts needed
Designer	\$2–6k	Or one-time \$2–8k
Part-time counsel	\$2–8k retainer	Before trading/agent fees
Risk analyst (curator)	\$8–20k	For vault curation only

Table: People costs — largest budget item after audits for funded teams.

5.4 True total by ambition

Ambition	90-day cash	12-month cash	Products
Read-only SaaS	\$500–5k	\$5–20k	#1, #2, #4
Trading UI no custom router	\$1–8k	\$8–25k	#3 phase 1
Agent templates	\$2–10k	\$15–40k	#5 phase 1
Custom DeFi + audit	\$40–120k	\$100–300k	#3 phase 2, #8
New lending / curator serious	\$150k+	\$300k–1M+	#9, #10

Table: All-in cash if founder codes; add salary if not.

6. Distribution Playbook

Robinhood Chain distribution is **not** “post a memecoin.” It is a mix of brokerage funnel leakage, Wallet users, Earn curiosity, and crypto-native Twitter. Match channel to product.

Channel	Cost	Best products	Tactics
SEO / content	Time / \$0–1k	#1 #2 #5	Earn explainers, ST tax guides, agent safety
X / CT	Time / \$0–2k	All	Data posts, dashboards, not shill coins
YouTube	Time / \$100–500	#1 #5	Walkthroughs of Earn + agents
Reddit (careful)	Time	#1	Answer risk questions; no spam
RH ecosystem BD	Time	Tooling	chain-developers-group@robinhood.com + metrics
Arbitrum Open House	Time	Any shipping	\$1M prize narrative for RH builders
Arbitrum Foundation grants	Time	Public goods	Rolling grants ~\$20–150k ARB cited range
KOL / affiliate	\$500–5k tests	#3 #7	Only with real product
In-product viral	Eng	#4 #3	Share PnL cards, alert links

Table: Distribution channels with cost and product fit.

Wallet distribution reality: ~28M customers are a funnel, not free users. Conversion to onchain is still tiny early. Design for the few who export, bridge, or open Earn/Wallet — make their first success obvious. Account abstraction + gas sponsorship (Alchemy) reduces drop-off.

7. Recommended Paths by Budget & Skills

Your situation	Build this	Avoid
Solo, <\$5k, can code FE/BE	#1 or #2 (+ #4 features)	Custom lending, SocialFi clone
Solo, non-US focus	#2 then #3 UI	US-only Earn assumptions
Solo, US focus	#1 then #5 templates	Stock Token primary product
Want fees from volume	#3 UI → fee later	Router without audit
Love AI, hate Solidity	#5 phase 1	Onchain agent day one
Have \$50k+ and Solidity	#6 + small fee contracts	Jumping to #10
Risk/TradFi background	Explore #9 carefully	CT growth hacks as core
Raising a fundraiser	#8 or #10 narrative + MVP #1/#2	Token-only no product

Table: Decision matrix by founder situation.

8. 90-Day Default Roadmap

Default path for most solo builders

Days 1–30: Ship product #1 (US) or #2 (non-US) read-only MVP. Landing page, waitlist, first 20 users. Days 31–60: Paid tier live; add alerts (#4). Apply Arbitrum Open House / grants. Email RH ecosystem with metrics. Days 61–90: Add #3 swap deep-links; first revenue target \$500–2k MRR. Only then plan contracts.

- **Week 1–2:** Pick geo (US Earn vs non-US ST). Validate 10 interviews. Sketch data sources (Morpho, RPC, ST list).
- **Week 3–4:** MVP dashboard live on mainnet data. Public URL. Discord/Telegram support.

- **Week 5–6:** Pricing page. Stripe. First paid user. Iterate on clarity of risk copy.
- **Week 7–8:** Alerts + shareable report cards. Content engine (2 posts/week).
- **Week 9–10:** Swap quotes / Uniswap links for ST. Measure conversion.
- **Week 11–12:** Grant deck. Ecosystem email. Decide if agent pack is worth phase-2.

9. Regulatory & Landmine Checklist

Topic	Rule of thumb	Product impact
Stock Tokens	Not for US persons; debt exposure ≠ share ownership	Geo gates mandatory on #2 #3 #7
Earn / USDG	Not a bank; variable APY; incentives can end	#1 must show risk + incentive split
Insurance	RH policy ≠ user personal claim; not FDIC	Never market “insured yield” carelessly
Agents	User-controlled; no guaranteed alpha	#5 #8 = tools not advisors
Advice language	Education/tools ≠ personalized advice	All SaaS products
Swap fees	May trigger broker/MSB issues by country	Counsel before #3 fees scale
Copy trading	Often regulated as advice/brokerage	Legal budget for #7
Custody	Avoid holding user keys/funds	Prefer non-custodial always
Tokens	Token-first raises scam + legal risk on RH brand	Product + fees first

Budget \$2–10k legal review before meaningful trading/agent fees; more if targeting US retail at scale. This guide is not legal advice.

10. Sources & Further Links

- Robinhood Chain: <https://robinhood.com/us/en/chain/> · docs: <https://docs.robinhood.com/chain/>
- Ecosystem: <https://robinhood.com/us/en/chain/ecosystem/>
- Mainnet newsroom (July 1, 2026): Stock Tokens, Earn, agents, DeFi partners
- Robinhood Earn support: <https://robinhood.com/us/en/support/articles/crypto-earn/>
- Agentic Trading: <https://robinhood.com/us/en/agentic-trading/> · MCP trading endpoint documentation in support articles
- Morpho / Steakhouse curation model (public Morpho + Steakhouse materials)
- Arbitrum Open House: <https://openhouse.arbitrum.io/> · Grants: <https://arbitrum.foundation/grants>
- Developer contact: chain-developers-group@robinhood.com
- Audit cost landscape 2026: industry references (e.g. Sherlock market notes, audit firm guides)
- Network: Chain ID 4663 mainnet · RPC via Alchemy / public rpc.mainnet.chain.robinhood.com

Closing Recommendation

Sort products by **easy** → **hard**, but choose by **revenue × distribution ÷ difficulty**. For most builders that formula peaks at **#1 Earn intelligence (US)** or **#2 Stock Token portfolio (non-US)**, then **#3 UI-only swap**. Hard products (#8–#10) have higher ceilings and higher death rates — fund them with revenue or capital, not hope.

You provide value when you make Earn understandable, Stock Tokens operable, trades clearer, or agents safer — and charge for that job. You do not need to beat SocialFi clones or rebuild Morpho on day one.

— End of guide —

Research synthesis for product planning only. Not an offer or solicitation. Costs and ecosystem details change rapidly — re-verify before spending money or shipping financial features.